In its judgement the court agreed with the prison administration's step and commended the IG (P)'s stand with a remark that this step should have been taken a long time ago.

But what about restraints on solitary confinement?

'There was no solitary confinement in our jails,' asserted Kishore. 'These prisoners, who were in the high-security ward, had a cell to themselves. They could talk to others and were in view of the ward's courtyard. They could even interact with each other in their own courtyard. This was not solitary confinement where the prisoner could not even hear or see another person. That was not permitted because at times it led to severe neuroses. What we had here was only isolation from the larger body of prisoners.'

'Guruji', the teacher undertrial in Tihar, reflected:

> These big smugglers and gangsters would terrorize the other inmates. They were identified and all of them were put into cells in the same ward and isolated from the rest and not even allowed to move about in their ward. But now they have been allowed to get together for meals. And surprisingly, they don't fight amongst themselves any more. This has done the rest of the prison a lot of good and I'm sure for the first time they must also be learning something.

The fact that the rest of the prisoners were so participative in the changing scenario of the jail indicated that this move had certainly acted as an effective deterrent to any possible and potential troublemaker and rabble-rouser.

By and large there was always a tremendous positive response from the prisoners whenever the IG came in contact with them. This was indicative of the trust they reposed in her and the direction in which she was moving for the amelioration of their condition. Therefore, wasn't she a little disturbed by the animosity that these isolated gangster-prisoners must be holding towards her?

'No,' Kiran reflected, 'there was no tangible animosity. I would say they had a sort of neutral stance. You see, even they realized that I was not doing this to them out of spite or to just make things easier for myself. They knew that I had never ever arrested anyone wrongly. They were even very much aware of the fact that whenever I did make an arrest I followed the case to its conclusion. I never gave up on the persons but continued to pursue their rehabilitation and correction. For this I even interacted with their families and, where need be, I did my utmost to help them as best as I could.'

She cited a specific instance: 'I remember when I arrested Vinod Tyagi (a notorious gang leader), he never pleaded innocence before me. All he told me was that his wife was having some health problems. So, we ensured that she got the right treatment. She was admitted to hospital and had a safe delivery. Even afterwards we kept ourselves informed of her condition. I have always felt that a person must be punished for the wrongs he does, but also, we must not make any lapses in our attempt to help make him a corrected and better human being. There was a man in the high-security wards who spent time with Vinod Tyagi then. Even he admitted I have done no wrong to them.'

She finally expressed her optimism: 'I knew these people would ultimately respond. Then I intended to gradually extend all the facilities to them also.'

In a gesture honouring her intentions, these isolated gangster-prisoners were provided facilities to watch on TV the 1994 Wimbledon tennis matches and the World Cup football championships in their barracks.

Help was sought from voluntary agencies outside and an Ayurvedic-cum-homoeopathic clinic under the aegis of the Central Health Services Scheme was installed within the prison. Medical